RegFire Business Plan

Internal strategy and investor planning

October 5, 2026 | Version 1 | Management review draft

Decision in brief

Build RegFire as one registration platform for ticketed events and badge-based events. Both must work at initial commercial launch. Start selling to repeat organizers with manageable event sizes, then expand event categories as operational proof grows.

The inspected product is a local organizer application with meaningful configuration and preview capabilities. It is not yet evidenced as a production ticketing or onsite badging business. The first investment decision is whether to fund and validate the complete purchase-to-entry experience, not whether to market the current preview as finished software.

What this plan provides

A launch definition, evidence-based product assessment, primary-source competitor research, pricing experiments, sales and service operating model, milestone gates, risk controls, and three financial scenarios. Investor-facing sections explain the opportunity and capital case; operating sections specify decisions, owners and proof required before scale.

Evidence and assumptions

Current capability statements are based on read-only source and document inspection on October 5, 2026. No production transactions, customer records, live AI responses, printer tests or security certification were verified for this plan. Historical test claims are not fresh test results. All proposed prices, hiring levels, dates, customer counts and financial outcomes are assumptions unless explicitly sourced.

No existing revenue, customers, funding, valuation, founder biography or team credentials are asserted. Legal entity, ownership, available cash, obligations and intellectual property assignments require founder confirmation. The marketing website and teaser are separate from the registration application.

Financial headline

The illustrative base case reaches $0.214 million, $0.881 million and $2.490 million in annual revenue across the first three commercial years, with operating break-even in Year 3. A provisional $1.8 million funding envelope covers a modeled six-month preparation phase, the first two commercial years of losses and a contingency buffer. These are decision tools, not forecasts or a financing commitment.

Plan navigation and executive summary

Read pages 3–7 for the market and investment case, pages 8–16 for product and operating decisions, pages 17–21 for financials, and pages 22–25 for risks, validation and evidence.

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Investment thesis

Organizers need to collect the right information, charge correctly, issue an admission credential and recognize that same person at the door. RegFire can compete by making those tasks one coherent workflow, with branded attendee experiences and clear organizer controls. Success depends on reducing event setup and reconciliation effort without introducing event-day risk.

Initial commercial promise

Launch with two supported journeys: paid or free general-admission tickets with QR validation, and paid or free named registration with badge production and check-in. A single attendee can use both. A focused initial hardware and event-size envelope is compatible with the broader vision of serving any registration or ticketed event.

Commercial discipline

Recruit six to ten design partners, deliberately covering both launch journeys, before committing to broad acquisition spend. Require measured setup time, correct settlement, working entry controls and willingness to pay. Do not substitute a compelling demo or a large list of feature requests for evidence of repeated use.

What would change this plan

Higher service demand, lower event frequency or weak retention can make a low per-ticket fee uneconomic. Poor reliability can end a customer relationship after one event. Management should review launch evidence weekly and pricing, cohort economics and cash monthly. The downside case remains loss-making in all three years and requires an explicit stop, redesign or financing decision.

Customer problem and value proposition

A complete event identity

A ticket answers whether someone has admission. A badge adds identity, organization and role. RegFire should treat both as credentials attached to the same registration record, not separate products with separate lists. The organizer should be able to define the offer, collect relevant information, receive payment, issue credentials and reconcile attendance in one place.

Jobs to be done

- For organizers: publish a branded flow quickly, assign different registration paths, apply prices and eligibility rules, correct orders safely and see who registered, paid and arrived.
- For buyers and attendees: understand the full cost, complete a mobile-friendly form, receive a reliable confirmation, retrieve the ticket and enter without repeating information.
- For event staff: search or scan rapidly, identify invalid or duplicate credentials, print the right badge and recover from a printer or network interruption.
- For finance and administrators: reconcile orders, fees, refunds and payouts; control access; retain an audit history and export usable records.

Positioning to test

RegFire is a configurable registration and ticketing platform for organizers who need their online registration and onsite arrival to work together. The initial promise is practical control and reliable execution, with transparent fees and support appropriate to the event.

This is a positioning hypothesis. Competitors already offer branding, ticketing and badging in different combinations. No exclusive technical advantage, proprietary dataset or proven cost advantage is established. RegFire must demonstrate faster configuration, fewer handoffs and better service economics in matched pilots.

Potential defensibility

Over time, reusable organizer templates, tested device configurations, event-specific operational knowledge and integrations could increase retention. Those advantages require customer permission, portable data and dependable service. Avoid lock-in through inaccessible exports. Spark may reduce organizer help requests after quality evaluation, but AI is not a substitute for reliable payment or admission controls.

Pilot value measures

Record the organizer’s current workflow before the pilot. Compare setup hours, manual spreadsheet transfers, correction effort, peak arrival wait and post-event reconciliation time. Use customer-verified before-and-after measurements; do not promise a percentage improvement before the baseline exists.

Market focus and bottom up opportunity

Assumed first geography: United States, English-language support and USD settlement. This is a practical starting hypothesis, not a restriction on the long-term vision. International tax, currency, privacy and support requirements need separate readiness reviews before expansion.

Segment	Initial fit	Proof needed
Repeat association and conference organizers	High; paid registration plus identity badges	Repeat events and willingness to pay for configuration
Training firms and professional workshops	High; repeat ticketing with optional badges	Low-friction checkout and reusable setup
Independent producers and community events	High for general admission	Price sensitivity and peak scanning performance
Corporate meetings and agencies	Selective; branded multi-role events	Procurement, permissions and service boundaries
Stadium seating and major festivals	Later scale envelope	Reserved seats, burst demand and specialized entry operations

Prioritize repeat organizers with roughly 100–2,000 attendees per event and 4–12 events per year, plus selected smaller ticketed pilots. These ranges are assumptions for discovery. Both ticketing and badging remain launch requirements; segment focus determines sales priority, not which of the two ships.

External demand context

BLS reports approximately 172,100 meeting, convention and event planner jobs in 2025 and projects 6% employment growth from 2025 to 2035. This establishes a substantial professional user population; jobs are not software-buying organizations and cannot be used as RegFire's customer count or total addressable market. [S1]

An explicit sizing hypothesis

For planning only, assume 10,000 reachable US organizations with 4,000 chargeable registrations per year. At a blended $1.25 usage fee plus 60% subscription adoption at $1,788 per year, annual core revenue potential is $60.728 million. A first segment of 2,000 such organizations implies $12.146 million. Neither account count is externally validated, and the subset must not be added to the wider pool.

Year 3 base-case ending accounts of 380 would represent 19% of that assumed 2,000-account segment—an aggressive penetration requirement. Verify the account universe by building a deduplicated prospect list, interviewing buyers and checking annual event volume. Do not pitch an unsupported global market-size number; ticket face value is not software revenue.

Competitive landscape

Primary-source desk research reviewed October 5, 2026. Prices vary by geography, volume and contract; figures below describe the cited public pages, not binding quotes. RegFire prices on page 7 are untested proposals.

Provider	Public pricing evidence	Relevant competitive strength
Eventbrite	US: 3.7% + $1.79 per paid ticket; 2.9% of total order for processing. Free events have no ticketing fees. [S2]	Ticketing, discovery and promotional tools. RegFire should not assume it can replace marketplace demand.
Ticket Tailor	Page rendered GBP: £0.60 pay as you go; prepaid from £0.22, plus VAT and separate processing. No USD conversion inferred. [S3]	Flat-fee ticketing, branding and a check-in app create a strong low-cost benchmark.
TicketSpice	$0.99 per ticket plus stated standard processing of 2.9% + $0.30. Processor choice can add costs. [S4]	Custom ticketing pages and onsite sales. Flat pricing alone will not differentiate RegFire.
Cvent	Main suite uses requested quotes. Its trial also describes pay-as-you-go registration fees plus revenue share, disclosed in-product. [S5, S6]	Registration paths and OnArrival check-in, badge design and printing.
Whova	Quote request; no verified fixed price used. [S7, S8]	Event management, attendee engagement and badge-printing offering.

Strategic implications

RegFire sits between low-cost ticketing and more extensive event-management systems. It must earn that position through configuration usability and arrival execution, not an unsupported claim that competitors lack either. Offer transparent scope and a clear path from a simple ticket to named registration with badges.

Request comparable quotes before setting final commercial terms: same event count, attendee volume, support hours, badge stock, printers, onboarding, refund treatment and payment assumptions. No vendors were contacted for this plan. Ticket Tailor’s page has inconsistent free-ticket thresholds in different sections; confirm the limit rather than advertising a definitive comparison. [S3]

Competitive evaluation and route to advantage

Run a matched buying exercise

Use three representative scenarios: a 300-person paid workshop, a 1,000-person multi-role conference with badges, and a series of twelve 200-person general-admission events. Give each vendor the same requirements and score the completed workflow. Public feature pages do not establish relative usability, implementation cost or support quality.

Criterion	Weight	What to measure
Purchase and entry correctness	30%	Refunded and duplicate tickets, capacity, scan state and reconciliation
Setup and branding	20%	Time to publish three paths and safely revise fields
Total event cost	20%	Software, processing, hardware, consumables and labor
Reliability and recovery	20%	Offline behavior, device failure and data recovery
Support and portability	10%	Escalation response, export completeness and exit effort

Earnable advantages

The current configurable forms, branching previews and branded flow work provide a credible starting point for guided setup. A launch opportunity is to connect that foundation to one authoritative order and credential record, while keeping staff operations simple. Use a few proven templates and clear validation rather than unlimited configuration that generates support debt. [I1–I4]

Publish a fee calculator only after pricing validation. Let organizers see the buyer's total and their own net settlement before launch. Keep the ticketed entry experience and badge-based entry experience recognizable as the same platform; sell assistance explicitly instead of hiding labor inside a low transaction price.

Competitive responses

Low-cost providers can compress fees; broader suites can bundle registration and onsite tools. RegFire should respond with measurable workflow quality and renewal evidence. If support costs exceed gross profit, simplify the supported scope or raise prices rather than promising enterprise service at commodity ticketing rates.

Evidence for an investor process

A credible diligence pack should include signed pilot scope, measured time saved, event-day results, organizer references given with permission, cohort retention, actual gross margin and a security remediation log. Until those exist, describe the company as a product under development with a commercial validation plan.

Revenue architecture and price experiments

Proposed US prices, excluding taxes and third-party processing. No price is approved or validated. Both ticketing and badge functionality must be available at launch, with hardware, materials and staffing separately scoped.

Offer	Price hypothesis	Included boundary
Ticketing	No monthly fee; $0.99 per issued paid ticket	General admission, QR credential, online check-in; narrowly capped free-event trial
Registration and badging	$149 per month plus $1.50 per completed registrant	Branded paths, roles, badge templates, batch and supported onsite printing software
Assisted launch	$750 one-time setup package	Fixed deliverables and revision limit; complex imports quoted separately
Onsite assistance	$1,500 service fee per scoped engagement	Limited remote or partner-supported package; travel, staff, stock and rental separately quoted

Avoid double-charging a person who buys a ticket and receives a badge. Assign each registration one usage tariff. Comp, free and cancelled registration rules must be explicit; model volumes include only billable completed registrations net of assumed voids and credits. The $1.25 base-case realized usage fee represents a blend of tariffs and discounts, not an additional fee on top of either plan.

Payment economics

Pass processor charges through transparently under the selected payment arrangement. Stripe lists 2.9% + $0.30 for standard domestic card transactions; Connect, international, currency, dispute and other charges may apply. This rate is a planning benchmark, not RegFire's negotiated rate. [S9]

Example assumption: one $50 ticket, organizer absorbs fees, processor charges only the $50 amount. At $0.99 RegFire usage plus $1.75 processing, organizer net is $47.26 before tax or other charges. At $1.50 registration usage it is $46.75, plus the subscription allocation. Passing fees to the buyer changes the processing base; do not reuse the absorbed-fee arithmetic.

Validation before publication

Test three offers with at least 15 qualified buyers and secure six to ten scoped pilots. Compare paid conversion, realized fee, events per account, support time and objections. Try per-event minimums for infrequent organizers. Require a documented contribution margin for discounts. Physical badge materials and full onsite staffing are never assumed free.

Current product evidence and limits

Evidence class: source-observed implementation, not fresh runtime or production verification. Inspection used the local builder and marketing-site files, not private credentials or customer database contents. Product documents contain older statements that current source partly supersedes. [I1–I6]

Capability	Observed now	Launch implication
Organizer configuration	Event drafts, multiple flows, RegTypes, dated rates, demographics and conditional preview	Foundation exists; validate live submissions and versioned publish behavior
Branding	Welcome settings, fonts, backgrounds and a shared event footer	Carry to accessible production attendee pages
Sessions and membership	Session/speaker modules and import tests; membership CSV and provider-adapter code	Do not claim paid reservations, live provider verification or an attendee account
Access	Local sign-in, roles, event grants and route checks; test source for unauthorized event access	Newer than shared-workspace docs; requires independent production isolation assessment
Returning attendee path	Event recognition and placeholder future sign-in messaging	Not a working attendee authentication system
Spark	Authenticated chat adapter, constrained context, mocked-provider test source	Live inference quality and hosted deployment remain unverified
Commercial transactions	No complete order, settlement, ticket or print path found in inspected source	Build and prove ticketing and badging before launch

Important corrections to older notes

Do not say there is no login or no event-level restriction: access.py and access_http.py now enforce local identity, product grants and event assignments. Equally, do not call that a completed SaaS tenant model. The server still binds to loopback, admins have broad access, and production tenant, storage, background-job and export boundaries were not verified.

Proactive analytics alerts and AI throughout onsite services are intended launch positioning, not verified current capabilities. A page that resembles an attendee form does not establish accepted registrations. Browser-local agenda selections do not establish server-side reservations. A price preview does not establish payment collection. No current customer counts, paid orders or production uptime were inspected or inferred.

Initial launch product contract

Initial commercial release must include both columns below. A pilot can test them separately; general availability cannot defer badging or ticketing to a later roadmap. The supported scope must be stated in every proposal.

Shared foundation	Ticketed events at launch	Badge registration at launch
Published event and attendee record	Paid and free general admission	Paid and free named registration
Versioned prices and eligibility	Ticket types, capacity and inventory holds	Registration categories and role-based access
Order and payment state machine	Payment confirmation then credential issue	Payment or approved comp state before badge issue
Confirmation and retrieval	QR ticket email and resend/retrieval	Badge data validation and confirmation
Credential validation and audit	Duplicate, revoked and refunded scan states	Batch PDF plus one tested onsite print configuration
Operations and recovery	Refunds, cancellations and scan reconciliation	Corrections, authorized reprints and printer recovery

Shared minimum

The release needs responsive accessible checkout, durable attendee records, organizer permissions, transactional messaging, a financial ledger, exports, event limits, audit logs and clear consent/privacy notices. Server-side validation must determine prices, capacity and payment state. Client previews help organizers but never authorize admission or determine settlement.

Initial support envelope

Propose US/USD, general admission and named conference registration, one documented printer/stock/scanner bundle, and an event-size ceiling established by load and onsite tests. Publish the tested peak arrival rate, not an untested attendee maximum. Define one supported offline operating procedure with a safe reconciliation boundary.

Later breadth without a narrower launch

Reserved seating, marketplace discovery, RFID, complex exhibitor lead retrieval (working name: LeadFire), broad printer compatibility, multilingual operations and additional countries may follow proven demand. These are extensions to the two launch journeys, not reasons to omit paid ticketing or badges. Spark voice and autonomous event changes are not launch promises.

Build versus partner

Own registration, order/credential state, branding and staff workflows. Integrate payment acceptance, email delivery and a supported print route through established providers. Rent hardware or use a contracted onsite partner initially; do not build a nationwide equipment fleet before utilization and support costs are measured.

Release gates and acceptance evidence

A proposed accountable role owns each gate; no named employee is assumed. No calendar date overrides a failed gate. Maintain a signed evidence register with test environment, version, result, defects and remediation owner.

Gate and owner	Pass evidence required
G1 Scope and buyer validation Founder and product lead	Six scoped design partners, at least three ticketed and three badge-based; price and event constraints accepted in writing
G2 Identity and data boundary Engineering and security lead	Cross-client access tests for API, assets, search, exports and jobs; secure public deployment and independent review with no unresolved critical/high findings
G3 Money and orders Payments lead	Live controlled charge, partial/full refund, duplicate/reordered webhook handling, cancellation and daily reconciliation with no unexplained variance
G4 Credentials and onsite Operations lead	Two rehearsals per journey, revoked/duplicate detection, failed printer recovery and a documented offline reconciliation drill
G5 Capacity and recovery Engineering lead	At least twice forecast peak workload tested; no oversell in concurrent final-seat tests; restore database plus files within target recovery window
G6 Pilot outcomes Customer success lead	Completed pilots in both journeys, incident review, organizer sign-off, service cost tracking and two referenceable customers with consent
G7 General availability Founder	All gates accepted; staffed support calendar, approved terms, vendor contracts, operating cash and release rollback plan

Proposed service targets

Set initial goals of 99.9% monthly service availability, event-window critical incident acknowledgment within 10 minutes, transaction recovery point of no more than 15 minutes and recovery time within four hours. These are engineering and staffing targets, not current SLAs; event-day restoration may require tighter limits or an independent offline path.

Acceptance must include assistive-technology and mobile checkout, failed emails and self-service retrieval, timezone changes, order changes after printing, chargebacks and a complete event cancellation. Report results honestly; a mocked payment provider or a desktop screenshot is insufficient production evidence.

Payments security and data governance

Payment and settlement design

Prefer evaluating connected organizer accounts with hosted payment collection, subject to provider approval and a reviewed funds-flow design. Confirm who is merchant of record, who bears refunds and negative balances, and what happens if an organizer cancels after payout. Stripe's charge type changes which balance is debited for disputes; connected accounts do not automatically remove platform exposure. [S10]

Maintain immutable identifiers joining order, payment, refund, fee, payout and credential. Sign and deduplicate webhooks, tolerate out-of-order events, use idempotency on writes and reconcile to processor reports daily. A browser success page must never be the source of truth for payment completion. Keep ticket face value and organizer balances out of RegFire operating cash.

Security baseline

Before public use: enforce tenant and role boundaries server-side, HTTPS and secure sessions, administrator MFA, least-privilege service accounts, encrypted storage and backups, secret rotation, dependency updates, protected audit logs and tested incident response. Review privileged support access and revoke access promptly. Test exports and uploaded files, not just event API routes. Existing local controls are a starting point, not certification.

Use hosted or tokenized checkout so raw card data does not pass through RegFire. PCI obligations remain shared; integration design affects scope. Obtain provider or qualified assessor guidance on the applicable validation rather than claiming that using Stripe makes RegFire compliant. [S11]

Privacy and accessibility

Define organizer/platform data roles, retention, deletion, export, subprocessors and incident notification in reviewed agreements. Minimize badge and QR data; use opaque identifiers rather than personal details in codes. Separate marketing consent from transaction messages. Keep sensitive attendee data out of Spark until a reviewed data policy and provider agreement exist.

Use WCAG 2.2 AA as the acceptance target for registration and staff interfaces, including keyboard navigation, contrast, error recovery and status announcements. Accessibility conformance is not yet established. [S12]

Fee disclosure

For covered live-event ticket offers, the FTC rule requires prominent upfront total pricing inclusive of mandatory fees, with specified exceptions and final disclosure before payment. Build pricing presentation accordingly and obtain jurisdiction-specific legal review for fee, refund and tax rules. [S13]

Onsite badging and service operations

A supported operating system

Choose one initial printer and badge-stock configuration through physical trials. Document compatible operating systems, driver versions, connectivity, print dimensions and stock. Badge previews must match real output, including long names, Unicode, organization fields, accessibility needs and category colors. Keep reprints permissioned and logged.

Arrival workflow

Staff scan or search, verify current entitlement, resolve exceptions, print if needed and confirm entry. Failed or repeated print requests must not create duplicate registrations. Define whether reprinting revokes the old credential, and ensure door staff can see the correct state. Assign a separate exception desk for unpaid orders, mismatched names and damaged badges.

Checkpoint	Operating requirement
Two weeks before event	Confirm forecast peaks, equipment count, stock, staffing, venue network and escalation contacts
Day before	Rehearse paid, comp, cancelled, duplicate and walk-up cases; test backup network and spare printer
Opening period	Monitor queue and scan/print latency; isolate exceptions; keep one accountable event lead
Close and next day	Sync controlled offline records, reconcile entry and print exceptions, return equipment and document incidents

Size staffing from measured throughput

Illustration only: 600 arrivals in 30 minutes is 20 per minute. If a tested station completes one attendee in 15 seconds, theoretical capacity is four per minute. At a 70% planning utilization, required active stations are ceiling(20 ÷ 2.8) = eight, plus a spare and a separate exception station. Replace the assumed service time with measured scan-and-print results before quoting an event.

Offline and recovery

Define encrypted local roster access, device authentication, an event-specific snapshot, offline scan logs and conflict reconciliation. Independent offline scanners cannot guarantee global duplicate prevention without coordination; document this residual risk, use controlled lanes or a local shared network, and do not advertise perfect offline consistency. Limit offline payment acceptance until the processor-supported procedure is proven.

Commercial boundary

Separate software, hardware rental, consumables, travel and onsite labor in the statement of work. Confirm deposits, loss/damage responsibility, returns, accessibility accommodation and failure escalation. Any partner is proposed until a contract and rehearsal establish accountability.

Sales marketing and partnerships

Founder led discovery before broad spend

Build a focused list of repeat organizers and registration-service firms. Interview buyers about their last event, current bill, setup effort, entry failure points and renewal date. Use a working end-to-end pilot, not the cinematic teaser alone, to demonstrate the product. Record objections by segment and convert only opportunities that fit the tested support envelope.

Sales motion

Qualify event date, ticket/badge needs, peak arrivals, payment ownership, data migration and decision maker. Demonstrate the buyer's actual workflow; provide a written scope and all-in cost estimate. Run a paid pilot with explicit success criteria, then convert to a repeat-event agreement after reconciliation and a customer review. Do not promise a deadline without engineering and operations approval.

Funnel assumption	Commercial Year 1 base target
Target accounts reached through approved outreach	1,000
Qualified opportunities	240 or 24% of reached accounts
New customers	60 or 25% of qualified opportunities
Average pace	20 qualified opportunities and 5 wins per month
Acquisition budget	$100,000 selling and marketing; $1,667 per new logo

These are testable targets, not a current pipeline. At an assumed 45–90 day sales cycle, Year 1 conversion requires prelaunch opportunity development. Founder relationship access is unverified. Attribute sources and fully load sales costs before scaling a channel.

Marketing

Use clear pages for ticketing and badge registration, a transparent pricing explainer, guided demos and practical event-day checklists. Produce case studies only after customer approval. The existing teaser supports awareness; it does not prove product readiness. Prioritize search intent and referrals before broad paid media, and measure qualified opportunities rather than video views.

Partnerships

Evaluate independent meeting planners, venues, onsite registration providers and hardware rental firms as referral or delivery partners. Define lead ownership, commissions, service margins and support handoffs in writing. Integrations with association systems and CRMs should follow repeated demand. No current partnerships or negotiated provider terms are assumed.

Customer success and operating cadence

Onboarding and delivery

A customer success owner gathers event requirements, imports data through a validated template and configures the first workflow with the organizer. The organizer signs off on branding, prices, refund policy, emails and badge fields. Capture a published version before sales open. Rehearse one complete purchase and arrival on the actual supported devices.

Treat every material change after opening as controlled: changed rates affect new orders unless explicitly adjusted; deleting a question does not silently erase prior answers; refunds update credential validity. Maintain an organizer-readable change log and test rollback. Provide self-service correction only within clear limits.

Support model

Offer normal business-hours organizer support and separately contracted event-window coverage. A small team cannot credibly promise unlimited 24/7 human support. The event lead owns the escalation chain; engineering owns incidents; finance owns settlement exceptions. Publish communication intervals and a status page before general availability.

Renewal and expansion

Hold a post-event review within five business days. Reconcile dollars and attendance first, then discuss setup effort, support incidents, reprint rates and the next event. Seek an annual commitment only if event frequency warrants it. Expansion should come from additional events and organizers, not hidden fee increases.

Cadence	Decision and output
Weekly launch review	Gate evidence, defects, upcoming event readiness and blocked owners
Weekly commercial review	Pipeline quality, conversion, lost reasons and discount exceptions
Monthly operating review	Cohort retention, contribution margin, support hours, vendor spend and cash forecast
Quarterly board or advisor review	Strategy, risk appetite, funding milestones and scope of supported events

Data ownership and trust

Provide exports that retain order, attendee, payment and check-in identifiers with a documented schema. Do not use organizer attendee lists as an acquisition channel without authorization. Handle deletion and retention requests through a defined process that preserves legally required financial records where applicable. Vendor terms and local law need qualified review before promises are made.

Spark as a support experiment

Start with organizer guidance and draft text. Evaluate answer accuracy, refusal behavior, data handling, latency and cost on a curated question set. Require human review for event settings and financial instructions. Hosted production inference, model availability and voice support are not verified in the current source review. [I5]

Team and delivery responsibilities

This is a proposed staffing plan. Current headcount, employment commitments, compensation and founder experience have not been supplied. Roles may initially be combined, but sign-off accountability must remain clear.

Role	Initial responsibility	Hiring trigger
Founder and commercial lead	Customer validation, scope, pricing and fundraising	Immediate accountable owner; confirm time commitment
Technical lead	Architecture, tenant model, release quality and incident command	Before public data or paid pilots
Product engineer	Registration, checkout and staff workflow	Funded preparation phase
QA and onsite operations lead	Failure tests, hardware qualification and event runbooks	Before first physical badge rehearsal
Customer success and support	Onboarding, event readiness and renewals	When live calendar exceeds founder capacity
Fractional specialists	Payments, security, legal and finance review	Before launch gates G2–G4 and financing

Modeled cost envelope

Base recurring payroll is $420,000, $650,000 and $1,000,000 across commercial Years 1–3. These are loaded budget envelopes, roughly equivalent to 3, 4.5 and 6.5 blended full-time roles, not individual salary benchmarks or firm hiring commitments. General engineering, product and leadership sit in operating expense; direct support contractors sit in cost of revenue, so do not count the same wages twice.

Sales and marketing is modeled separately at $100,000, $220,000 and $400,000, including dedicated selling capacity and demand generation. General and administrative expense is $70,000, $110,000 and $180,000. Legal/security specialist work is included within these envelopes after launch; the preparation budget separately funds initial external review.

Execution safeguards

Require two people capable of releasing and restoring the system before commercial launch. Use peer review for payment, permission and credential changes. Keep production access minimal and auditable. Maintain a hardware spare and a documented partner escalation path before taking overlapping onsite commitments.

Founder diligence

Confirm legal entity, cap table, IP ownership, contractor assignments, trademarks, relevant event-industry experience, customer relationships and existing obligations. Insert only verified biography into investor materials. The website’s statements about industry experience are marketing copy, not independently substantiated credentials in this plan.

Milestones and management scorecard

Illustrative sequence begins when the team and budget are approved. Months are relative planning windows; no launch date has been committed. Commercial Year 1 starts only after launch gates pass.

Window	Outcome	Decision
Months 1–2	Buyer discovery; six signed pilot scopes; architecture, payment and hardware decisions	Confirm both launch journeys and revise costs before further hiring
Months 2–4	Persistent orders, checkout, ticket issuance, badge print path and production access controls	Proceed only with passing integration and isolation evidence
Months 4–6	Rehearsals, controlled live transactions and pilots in both journeys	G1–G7 sign-off or delay launch and reduce spend
Commercial Year 1	60 ending accounts; 120,000 billable registrations in base case	Validate retention and unit economics before scaling
Commercial Year 2	160 ending accounts; 550,000 registrations	Expand only proven channels and supported event types
Commercial Year 3	380 ending accounts; 1.62 million registrations	Base operating break-even; review next geography or enterprise scope

Targets to instrument

- Activation: time from approved configuration to first successful registration; initial goal within one business day for standard templates, measured after content receipt.
- Reliability: zero oversold admissions and zero unexplained reconciliation differences; track purchase success, delivery failures, scan failures and support incidents by event.
- Customer health: annual logo retention target 80% base, 70% downside, 85% upside; analyze ticket-only and badge customers separately.
- Economics: realized usage fee, support cost per account, service margin, acquisition payback and burn. Target core contribution payback below twelve months before expanding paid acquisition.
- Service: peak queue time, print failure and reprint rate; proposed 95th-percentile scan-to-result below two seconds under tested online load, measured independently of printing.

A launch delay triggers a reforecast, not silent movement of revenue into the same fiscal period. A three-month delay at the modeled preparation burn adds approximately $160,000 before any lost or displaced sales. Existing event dates, procurement windows and seasonality may make the commercial impact larger.

Financial model assumptions and formulas

All figures are illustrative USD planning assumptions. Year 1 is the first full twelve commercial months after a separate six-month preparation phase; Years 2 and 3 follow. No historical results are modeled. No valuation, investor return or guaranteed outcome is implied.

Driver	Base case	Scenario treatment
Ending active organizer accounts	60 / 160 / 380	Downside 24 / 60 / 120; upside 100 / 300 / 750
Annual logo churn	20% of opening accounts	30% downside; 15% upside
Average active accounts	Mean of opening and ending	Linear net account ramp; seasonality not modeled
Registrations per average account	4,000 / 5,000 / 6,000	Downside 3,000 / 3,500 / 4,000; upside 4,500 / 6,000 / 7,000
Realized usage fee	$1.25 per billable registration	$1.10 downside; $1.35 upside
Subscription	60% of average accounts × $149 × 12	Same adoption and rate in all scenarios
Assisted setup	50% of new accounts × $750	New accounts replace churn as well as add growth
Onsite services	20% of average accounts × $1,500	One engagement per attached account per year
Gross ticket value assumption	60% paid × $100 average face value	Illustrative volume only; excluded from revenue

Reproducible calculation

New accounts = ending accounts − opening accounts + churn × opening accounts. Usage revenue = average accounts × annual registrations per account × realized fee. Subscription revenue uses average accounts; ending subscription ARR uses ending accounts and is not total annual revenue. Setup and onsite fees are service revenue, not ARR.

Cost of revenue = $0.19 per registration + $900 per average account + 60% of service revenue + fixed infrastructure of $24,000 / $36,000 / $60,000. The $0.19 includes $0.12 delivery/hosting, $0.04 third-party platform allowance and $0.03 loss/service-credit provision. Reprice this allowance once payment architecture and vendor contracts are chosen.

Operating result = revenue − cost of revenue − payroll − sales/marketing − general/administrative expense. Research and development is expensed. Interest, income tax, depreciation, stock compensation and financing are excluded. This is an operating model, not audited GAAP statements; a cash bridge follows on page 21.

Base case three year operating model

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Average active accounts	30	110	270
Ending active accounts	60	160	380
New accounts including replacements	60	112	252
Billable registrations	120,000	550,000	1,620,000
Subscription revenue	32.2	118.0	289.7
Usage revenue	150.0	687.5	2,025.0
Setup revenue	22.5	42.0	94.5
Onsite service revenue	9.0	33.0	81.0
Total revenue	213.7	880.5	2,490.2
Cost of revenue	92.7	284.5	716.1
Gross profit	121.0	596.0	1,774.1
Gross margin	56.6%	67.7%	71.2%
Payroll	420.0	650.0	1,000.0
Sales and marketing	100.0	220.0	400.0
General and administrative	70.0	110.0	180.0
Total operating expenses	590.0	980.0	1,580.0
Operating result before D and A	-469.0	-384.0	194.1

Money rows in $000; account and registration rows are counts. Totals use unrounded values. A negative operating result indicates a loss. Preparation cost is excluded here and included in the funding bridge.

What has to be true

The business must retain 80% of opening accounts, win 60 / 112 / 252 new accounts, and increase annual usage per account. Year 3 operating profit is only $194,056; pricing or support-cost slippage can erase it. Base ending subscription ARR is $64,368 / $171,648 / $407,664. Usage and service income are excluded from ARR because event timing and volume are variable.

Illustrative gross ticket value is $7.2 million / $33.0 million / $97.2 million. This belongs to organizers before their fees, refunds and taxes; none is counted as RegFire revenue or financing capacity. The model assumes processor fees are separately borne by the organizer/buyer under the approved arrangement.

Downside and upside scenarios

The downside combines slower adoption, lower activity, weaker retention and fee pressure. The upside requires more new customers, more events per account and better realized pricing. Neither scenario is a probability-weighted forecast.

Downside case

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Ending active accounts	24	60	120
Billable registrations	36,000	147,000	360,000
Revenue	65.1	235.6	548.8
Cost of revenue	49.2	119.0	243.2
Operating expenses	480.0	630.0	860.0
Operating result	-464.1	-513.5	-554.3
Gross margin	24.4%	49.5%	55.7%

Upside case

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Ending active accounts	100	300	750
Billable registrations	225,000	1,200,000	3,675,000
Revenue	409.9	1,975.2	5,867.6
Cost of revenue	143.2	528.4	1,436.6
Operating expenses	750.0	1,470.0	2,710.0
Operating result	-483.4	-23.2	1,721.0
Gross margin	65.1%	73.2%	75.5%

Money rows in $000. Downside sales/marketing budgets are $70k / $100k / $150k; payroll $350k / $450k / $600k; G&A $60k / $80k / $110k. Upside equivalents are $160k / $420k / $850k, $500k / $900k / $1,600k, and $90k / $150k / $260k. Gross new account equivalents may be fractional because churn is an expected-value assumption.

Downside cumulative preparation plus operating losses reach $1.852 million by the end of Year 3, before working capital and equipment. A $1.8 million raise does not fund that full path. If conversion and retention track downside, stop discretionary hiring, revise support scope and pricing, and choose a financing or orderly scale-back path before cash is tight. Upside cash is not permission to ignore event-day staffing or security gates.

Unit economics and sensitivity

Base Year 2 mature account economics

Core revenue per average account is 5,000 × $1.25 + 60% × $1,788 = $7,322.80 per year. Variable delivery and risk cost is 5,000 × $0.19 = $950, plus $900 direct support. Core contribution is $5,472.80 or 74.7%, before fixed infrastructure, services and operating payroll. This is a blended account; report separate cohorts after pilots.

Base Year 2 acquisition cost proxy is $220,000 sales/marketing ÷ 112 new accounts = $1,964.29. Contribution payback is approximately 4.3 months, assuming usage is earned evenly; event seasonality can materially extend actual cash payback. The proxy excludes any founder sales time still charged to general payroll and is therefore not fully loaded until time allocation is measured.

At 20% annual churn, the simple contribution/churn heuristic is $27,364 and LTV/CAC is 13.9×. That result is likely optimistic for an unproven cohort: it assumes stable volume, margin and retention indefinitely, with no discounting. Use a conservative two-year retained contribution test instead: $5,472.80 × (1 + 80%) = $9,851, or 5.0× CAC. Neither is observed customer lifetime value.

Base Year 3 change	Approximate operating impact
Usage fee falls by $0.25	−$405,000; result becomes about −$211,000
Volume falls 20% with accounts unchanged	−$343,440 contribution; result becomes about −$149,000
Direct support cost doubles	−$243,000; result becomes about −$49,000
Third-party unit cost rises $0.10	−$162,000; result falls to about $32,000
Registration volume needed for break-even	About 1.437 million, holding other Year 3 inputs fixed

Pricing decision rules

Do not scale a channel on an apparently low CAC if accounts run only one event or require custom onsite labor. Measure gross profit after refunds, service credits, referral commissions and direct assistance. Reconcile trial and comp registrations to billing. A 2.9% processor charge on the base Year 3 gross ticket value alone would exceed $2.8 million if RegFire absorbed it; the modeled business cannot quietly absorb processing costs.

The fixed-price model places no percentage charge on ticket face value. If platform liability, fraud or payment economics require a percentage fee, rebuild conversion and margin assumptions instead of adding it invisibly.

Funding requirement and use of funds

Provisional base planning envelope: $1.8 million of new cash, assuming zero opening operating cash and no existing liabilities. This is not an approved raise, valuation or funding claim. Replace it with the founder's actual balance sheet and a monthly forecast before investor circulation.

Base funding bridge	USD
Six-month preparation cash budget	$320,000
Commercial Year 1 operating loss	$469,016
Commercial Year 2 operating loss	$383,992
Subtotal through 30 months from funding	$1,173,008
Equipment capex and incremental working capital allowance	$80,000
25% contingency on the subtotal plus allowance	$313,252
Indicative need with contingency	$1,566,260
Additional buffer to a $1.8 million envelope	$233,740

Preparation budget: $210,000 product/engineering/QA, $45,000 payments/security/legal review, $35,000 pilot and onsite testing, $15,000 hosting/tools, and $15,000 discovery. Spending is assumed even over six months for the delay sensitivity; actual hiring and testing payments will be uneven. Preparation spending is incremental to commercial-year operating expenses.

Illustrative cash bridge

With $1.8 million received at preparation start: cash after preparation is $1.480 million. Subtract Year 1 loss and $50,000 of equipment/working capital to leave $960,984. Subtract Year 2 loss and a further $30,000 to leave $546,992. Add Year 3 operating profit and subtract $40,000 further equipment/working capital to leave $701,048. Contingency is retained cash, not a second expense in this bridge.

This simplified bridge assumes operating result approximates cash before the stated increments: no debt service, tax, financing fees or opening payables; normal billing collections; no organizer-fund financing. It is not a full balance sheet or monthly runway guarantee. Seasonal receivables, payout holds, refunds, processor reserves and cancellation exposure require a separate treasury stress test.

Capital release and alternatives

Fund architecture and customer validation first; release wider commercial hiring after G3–G6 evidence. Alternatives include founder funding, paid pilots, services-funded development or an equity round. Do not fund operations from ticket proceeds. Begin the next financing or spending-reduction decision with at least nine months of forward cash coverage under the downside plan.

Risk register and contingency actions

Risk	Early signal	Owner and response
Incomplete dual launch	Ticket checkout works but badging or entry fails	Product: keep launch blocked; ship both journeys inside the tested envelope
Cross-client data exposure	Unexpected event, asset or export access	Security: stop affected access, investigate, remediate and retest all boundaries
Event cancellation and payment loss	Refund demand exceeds organizer balance	Finance: reserves, reviewed liability terms and staged payout policy with provider
Onsite failure	Print/scan errors or queue growth	Operations: spare device, exception desk, local recovery plan and rehearsed escalation
Weak repeat usage	Fewer events or renewal commitments	Commercial: analyze segment economics; revise offer or stop acquisition spend
Hidden service burden	Support hours exceed account contribution	Success: fixed scope, paid assistance, template simplification and repricing
Price compression	Discounts needed to win standard deals	Founder: prove service value and monitor contribution by cohort
AI or integration failure	Incorrect guidance, timeouts or data concerns	Engineering: keep Spark advisory, human fallback and clear provider boundaries
Key-person dependency	Only one release or recovery operator	Founder: documentation, second operator and cross-training
Capital shortage	Downside cash coverage below nine months	Founder/finance: freeze optional spend and choose raise, scope reduction or exit

Risk that cannot be solved with a disclaimer

A failed admission system at a live event can damage the organizer’s reputation immediately. Limit sales to an event size and staffing configuration supported by evidence. Contractual limitations, insurance and vendor terms matter, but they do not replace functional capacity control, tested recovery and available staff.

Investor disclosure discipline

Disclose prototype status, remaining launch work, reliance on vendors, uncertainty in customer acquisition and unverified unit economics. Avoid customer logos, testimonials, bookings, secured partnerships, compliance claims or founder credentials without supporting records and permission. Keep a dated claim register with an owner and evidence link for every material investor statement.

Validation questions and next decisions

The plan is complete as a first planning draft. These answers should replace assumptions before committing to prices, a launch date or a financing amount; their absence should not be hidden in investor materials.

Decision	Specific validation question	Next evidence
Founder and legal	Which entity owns the code and brand, who holds equity, and what obligations already exist?	Cap table, incorporation/IP records, current cash and commitments
Commercial priority	Which repeat organizers can participate in a paid pilot, and when are their next events?	Named opt-in pipeline with size, journey and decision dates
Launch capacity	What attendee peak and hardware configuration must the first events support?	Arrival forecasts, venue constraints and timed physical trials
Price willingness	Will buyers accept $0.99 ticketing or $149/month plus $1.50 registration?	Recorded price tests and paid pilot contracts
Payment responsibility	Who is merchant of record and who funds refunds or negative balances?	Provider-approved flow and reviewed commercial terms
Resources and timing	What founder time, engineering capacity and cash are actually available?	Monthly staffing and cash plan tied to gates
Customer data	Which data must be collected, retained, exported and deleted?	Data map, agreements, retention schedule and threat model
Proof of value	What must improve over the buyer’s current workflow to justify switching?	Baseline and agreed pilot measures

First thirty days after approval

Name accountable gate owners; confirm cash and legal ownership; recruit a balanced ticketing/badging pilot cohort; interview at least fifteen qualified buyers; select a payment architecture and one print setup; document the production data model and tenant boundary; and turn the financial assumptions into a monthly operating forecast with actual quotes.

Decision at the end of discovery

Proceed if both launch journeys have committed pilot demand, delivery costs fit an acceptable contribution margin and the security/payment/onsite work is fundable. If one side lacks demand, revise the sales focus while preserving the user’s requirement that both capabilities be ready at launch. If budget is insufficient, change the timeline or financing plan rather than relabeling unfinished work as production-ready.

External source register

Primary sources reviewed October 5, 2026. Public pages can change; refresh commercial prices and legal requirements before a launch or investment decision. Source numbers appear beside the relevant claims. Vendor descriptions are their own claims, not independent performance verification.

S1 US Bureau of Labor Statistics — https://www.bls.gov/ooh/business-and-financial/meeting-convention-and-event-planners.htm

S2 Eventbrite US ticketing fees — https://www.eventbrite.com/help/en-us/articles/755615/how-much-does-it-cost-for-organizers-to-use-eventbrite/

S3 Ticket Tailor pricing — https://www.tickettailor.com/pricing

S4 TicketSpice pricing — https://www.ticketspice.com/pricing

S5 Cvent suite pricing and OnArrival — https://www.cvent.com/en/event-management-software/cvent-pricing

S6 Cvent registration trial and pay as you go — https://www.cvent.com/en/event-management-software/free-trial

S7 Whova pricing quote request — https://whova.com/pricing/

S8 Whova badge printing — https://whova.com/event-management-software/event-badge-printing-software/

S9 Stripe standard US pricing — https://stripe.com/pricing

S10 Stripe Connect charge types and disputes — https://docs.stripe.com/connect/charges

S11 Stripe security and PCI responsibilities — https://docs.stripe.com/security/guide

S12 W3C WCAG 2.2 — https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/

S13 FTC fees rule guidance — https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/rule-unfair-or-deceptive-fees-frequently-asked-questions

Research notes: Eventbrite’s direct pricing page returned a rate limit; its official help page and indexed official pricing result supported the quoted fee structure. Whova’s direct pricing fetch was restricted; its official indexed quote-request page was available. Ticket Tailor rendered GBP pricing, so this plan does not infer USD prices. No customer or sales inquiries were submitted.

Product evidence and model audit trail

Read-only inspection date: October 5, 2026. Builder root: /Users/mikeblaze/Documents/Codex/2026-09-29/regfire-event-creation/outputs/regfire. Corporate root: /Users/mikeblaze/Documents/ChatGPT/RegFire. No application code, deployments, accounts or customer data were changed for this plan.

ID	Source files and interpretation
I1	README.md; docs/ARCHITECTURE.md; docs/API.md; docs/REGISTRATION_BUILDER.md. Local organizer foundation and documented preview limits; older statements cross-checked against newer code.
I2	server.py; registration.py; demographics.py; database.py. Draft/flow endpoints and local binding; no complete production checkout or badge path found in the reviewed scope.
I3	access.py; access_http.py; tests/test_event_access.py. Local roles and per-event enforcement supersede older shared-workspace wording. Test files inspected, not rerun.
I4	SESSIONS-AND-BRANDING.md; sessions.py; event_footer.py; welcome.py. Sessions/imports, shared footer and typography foundation; some document details may lag flow-specific code.
I5	docs/SPARK.md; spark_chat.py; tests/test_spark_chat.py. Advisory chat adapter and mock tests; no real inference or hosted availability tested.
I6	static/registrant-login.js; static/email.js; docs/OPERATIONS.md. Returning-attendee placeholder, email format checks rather than delivery, and local backup procedures.

Model audit notes

All modeled volumes, conversion rates, churn, cost envelopes and capital needs are explicit hypotheses. The companion JSON holds input values and unrounded annual outputs for reproducibility; the Word tables remain editable. Figures are rounded for display only. A monthly cash model should add event seasonality, collections, tax, processor reserves and actual hiring dates before use as a fundraising budget.

The model intentionally excludes organizer funds from revenue and cash. Service fees are gross revenue with 60% direct service cost; third-party hardware/stock/travel billed directly are outside modeled revenue. If RegFire instead resells those items, add both revenue and corresponding costs and re-evaluate principal-versus-agent accounting with an accountant.

Readiness limitation

This plan is a business and product assessment, not a penetration test, legal opinion, tax determination or production acceptance certificate. No runtime regression suite was executed because the task was read-only and existing tests create temporary database schemas. Historical test totals were not represented as current passes. Source-observed functions should be validated in the launch environments before being used in contractual claims.